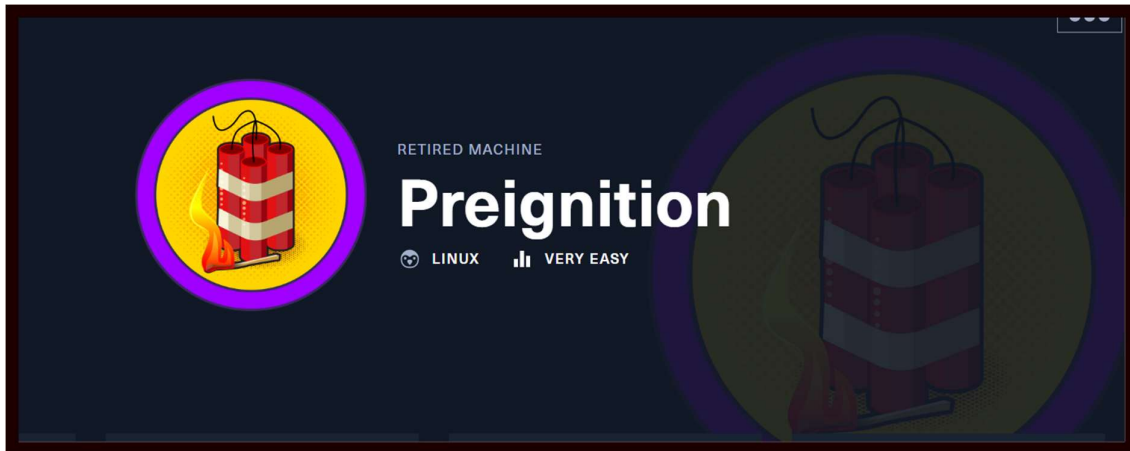


Hello everyone!

In this walkthrough, we'll solve the Preignition CTF room on HackTheBox by performing enumeration.



Description

Web servers are vital in IT infrastructures, often exposing content publicly. For example, a WordPress site has a public-facing page and a private admin panel (/wp-admin). Admin access provides control over content, themes, and scripts. These panels can be vulnerable if outdated, making web enumeration, specifically directory busting, crucial in penetration testing.

Web Enumeration & Directory Busting

Directory busting helps identify hidden directories and files on a website that aren't accessible through normal browsing. Tools like dirbuster or gobuster can automate this process, revealing valuable attack vectors such as admin panels or misconfigured files. It's a key skill for penetration testers to uncover potential vulnerabilities.

Step 1: - In this step, verify whether the target is reachable using the **ping** command, then perform **port scanning** and **service/version detection** using **Nmap**.

ping -c 4 10.129.21.91

sudo nmap -sC -sV 10.129.21.91

```
(hacker@kali)-[~/Desktop/HTB/Preignition]
$ ping -c 4 10.129.21.91
PING 10.129.21.91 (10.129.21.91) 56(84) bytes of data:
64 bytes from 10.129.21.91: icmp_seq=1 ttl=63 time=821 ms
64 bytes from 10.129.21.91: icmp_seq=2 ttl=63 time=257 ms
64 bytes from 10.129.21.91: icmp_seq=3 ttl=63 time=279 ms
64 bytes from 10.129.21.91: icmp_seq=4 ttl=63 time=278 ms

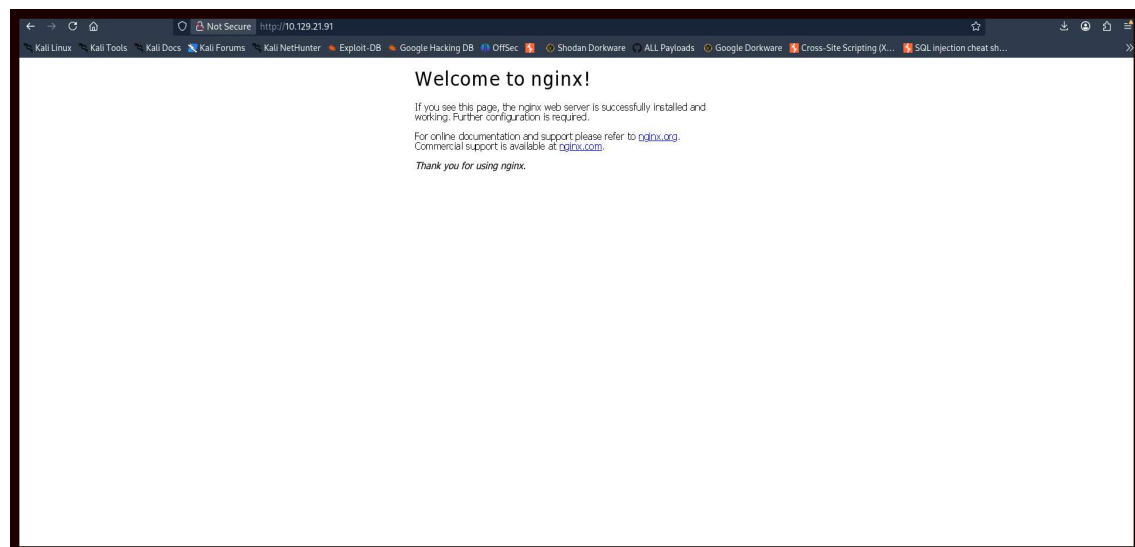
--- 10.129.21.91 ping statistics ---
4 packets transmitted, 4 received, 0% packet loss, time 3005ms
rtt min/avg/max/mdev = 257.203/408.612/820.517/237.970 ms

(hacker@kali)-[~/Desktop/HTB/Preignition]
$ sudo nmap -sC -sV 10.129.21.91
[sudo] password for hacker:
Starting Nmap 7.95 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-01-08 05:15 IST
Nmap scan report for 10.129.21.91
Host is up (0.74s latency).
Not shown: 999 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
80/tcp    open  http      nginx 1.14.2
|_http-server-header: nginx/1.14.2
|_http-title: Welcome to nginx!

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 28.43 seconds
```

Step 2: In this step , I am accessing the website using its IP address.

<http://10.129.21.91/>



Step 3: In this step, we performed directory brute-forcing using DIRB.

dirb <http://10.129.21.91/>

```
(hacker@kali)-[~/Desktop/HTB/Preignition]
$ dirb http://10.129.21.91/

-----
DIRB v2.22
By The Dark Raver
-----

START_TIME: Thu Jan  8 05:25:01 2026
URL_BASE: http://10.129.21.91/
WORDLIST_FILES: /usr/share/dirb/wordlists/common.txt

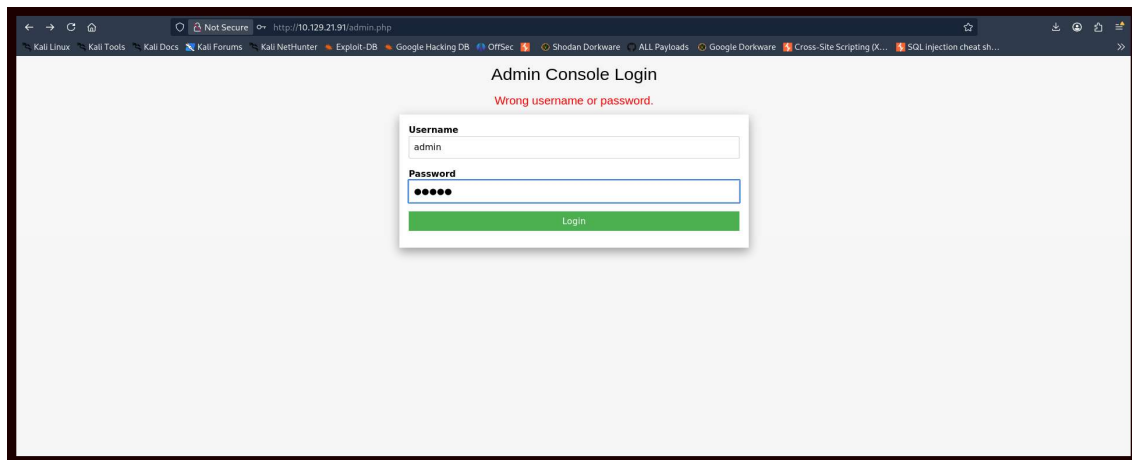
-----

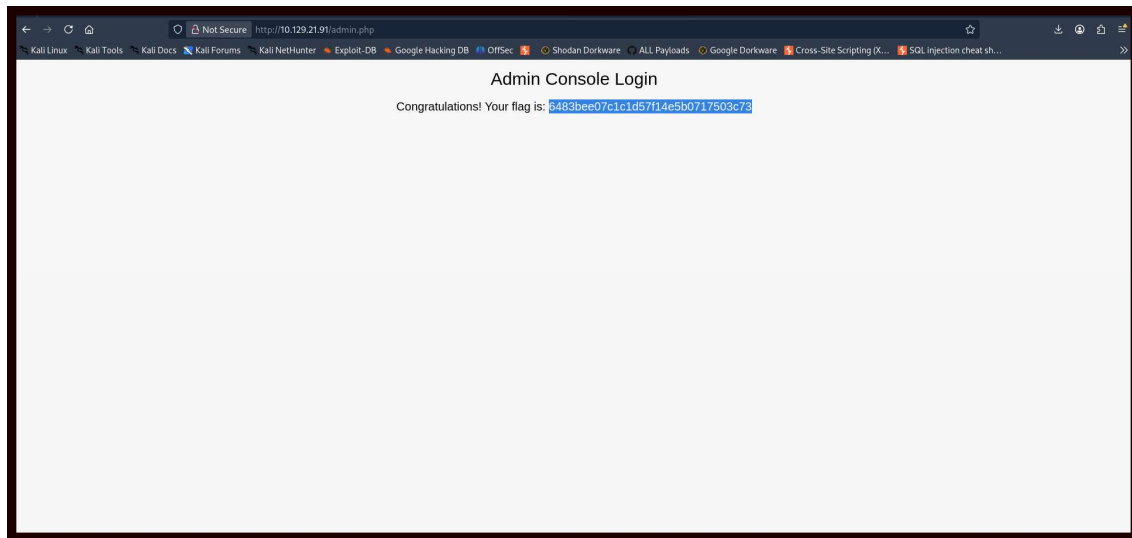
GENERATED WORDS: 4612

---- Scanning URL: http://10.129.21.91/ ----
+ http://10.129.21.91/admin.php (CODE:200|SIZE:999)
```

Step 4: In this step, I accessed the admin.php page and attempted to log in using default credentials, such as "admin" for both the username and password.

<http://10.129.21.91/admin.php>





Thank you for visiting